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Subject: [External] AI Action Plan Concerns
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The idea of allowing generative AI to be trained on copyrighted work without limit or compensation is a violation of the Fifth Amendment. We as citizens are allowed to keep personal property, including ideas (intellectual property) and maintain the rights over them. When people are hungry, we do not force companies or individuals to give up their own food or resources without thanks or compensation; we especially would not force a farmer to give up his produce for free so that a store might sell those vegetables for profit, but both of these analogies are exactly what OpenAI wants to do.

These companies want to be able to cannibalize the hard work of individuals, with no recognition or compensation for their work being used to train this software, and then CHARGE OTHERS to use it. Either pay for the privilege of learning from other people's creative works (and allow them to say no) or OpenAI should be entirely not for profit and free to use by anyone without limits. (If the data they collected to train their software was truly free and had no value, then their product should be considered the same.)

For all the fear mongering about China's AI eclipsing ours, are we really considering sacrificing America's unique creativity, individuality, and our right to make money from our own works just to make ChatGPT use fancier words when making up facts about birds? I can promise you that if we remove copyright protections in favor of OpenAI, our economy will buckle in on itself. No more movies or video games or TV, no more music or books or art, no more quality assurances or importance of brands. If everything I make can be taken and consumed by OpenAI, how is that any different than living in Communist China without any personal property or individuality at all?

AI has its place and its strengths, but it should not be allowed to supersede some of the most basic personal freedoms in this country in favor of progressing faster and for less money. Let people and companies exclude their work from AI training models. For f&^%'s sake.

--Saro Nortrup
Writer, artist, American

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